

ATLAS 31 / Second Earth (Original IP)

Project Type: Original IP – deep-space psychocosmic setting for a long-form narrative universe.

Focus: lore architecture, metaphysics, social systems, and narrative tone for a multi-layered world.

I developed the core worldbuilding and narrative systems for an original IP set aboard the generation-ship ATLAS 31 / Tzingalle Naba, travelling toward a mythic “Second Earth”. The goal was to build a setting where metaphysics, social hierarchy, rituals, and text fragments all work together.

My Role & Goals

Role: narrative architect and worldbuilding designer.

I designed the underlying logic of the world and expressed it through ship culture, rituals, language, and the voice of the main narrator.

Key goals:

- Turn abstract metaphysical ideas (Unity, Central Star, “Star Strangers”) into concrete world rules.
- Build a believable social structure on the ship (upper decks, the “Unpassed”, ritual initiations).
- Create recurring motifs (signals, journals, “Second Earth”, starvation and faith) that can support future stories, quests, or game scenarios.
- Keep the tone consistent: cosmic mysticism + decayed sci-fi + ritual horror.

Key Worldbuilding Systems

Core metaphysics & themes

- The universe as a reflection of fractured collective unconscious.
- The idea of Unity and the Central Star testing every traveler twice.
- Star Strangers are tested by intrusive thoughts and false dreams.

The ship – Tzingalle Naba (“The Woman Who Gives Life”)

- A colossal asteroid-ship carved into multi-level decks.
- Upper tiers: protected elites (“Untouchables”, officers, ritual specialists).
- Lower decks: “Unpassed” – irradiated workers, cannibalism, despair, failed initiations.
- Four suspension engines collect stellar energy from distant stars to feed the Hanging Gardens.

Ritual system – “Dushegubka” (Soul-Scalding Trial)

- Brutal initiation for anyone who wants to join the upper crew.
- Candidate is sealed in an ejection trash bag, nearly vented into space, then retrieved.

- *Those who survive gain status and access; those who fail become Unpassed in the lower decks.*
- *Function: bonds characters through shared trauma, removes fear of space, and creates a culture of death-as-gateway, not an end.*

Narrative frame & voice

- *Story told through Board Journals of Rebbe Homer / Solo-Navt.*
- *Mix of logbook, confession, and warning addressed to any future traveler receiving the signal.*
- *Supports episodic structure: each “recording” can become a story chapter, quest line, or game mission.*

Short Narrative Sample

We don't know if this signal will reach you.

If you hear us – this is a greeting.

A greeting from ATLAS 3I, from those who fly into the dark to search for light.

My name is Rebbe Homer, the only living crew member surrounded by a cocoon of dead darkness inside and out. We, the Haverists, left for Second Earth after receiving a mysterious signal — a pattern of symbols that decoded into something painfully similar to our own life.

We thought we'd reach it quickly. We were wrong. Over the years, our ship turned into a monstrous place called Tzingalle Naba – where the smell of rotten flesh meets new life. In its endless corridors wander creatures once proudly called the Last Hope. They eat each other, tear apart the ship's insides, and themselves.

Somewhere between the Hanging Gardens of the upper decks and the irradiated pits of the Unpassed below, I stand at the helm, hands bloody on the controls, trying to finish a journey that should never have begun – and to leave a warning for whoever receives this log after us.